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WELCOME BJP president J.P. Nadda (left) and Amit Shah congratulate new working president Nitin Nabin at the party HQ in Delhi, Dec. 15

▶ BJP

NEW-GEN LEADER

The party chooses low-key, five-term Bihar MLA Nitin Nabin to lead it into the future. But Modi-Shah's dominance in organisation affairs continues

By ANILESH S. MAHAJAN

ON THE EVENING OF DECEMBER 14, a short message from the Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) national media office announced Nitin Nabin, the low-key minister for public works in the new government in Bihar, as the party's 'working president', a preliminary step before taking over the top post nationally. At just 46, he'll be the youngest BJP president in history (breaking Nitin Gadkari's record, who was 52 when he took over) when he takes over as the party's national chief next year.

Born after the BJP was formally constituted in 1980, Nabin will also be the first millennial leader to enter/head the party's national organisational core. For many outside the party (and inside it too), the name had little recall. Inside the BJP, though, the appointment brought clarity, as it had been some time coming—current party chief J.P. Nadda has been on one extension after another since his tenure ended in January 2023.